8 Simple Rules for Dating My Teenage Daughter

By W. Bruce Cameron

INTRODUCTION

It seems to happen overnight. One minute your daughter is wearing bunny slippers and demanding bedtime stories. The next, she's wearing a midriff-baring tee shirt (WOLF WHISTLE), demanding the car keys and wanting to go out ALONE with guys like me. And while, as a teenager, I have difficulty understanding your discomfort; I have a feeling your innermost thoughts may run something like this:

8 Simple Rules for Dating my Daughter by W. Bruce Cameron.

(Pg 229+) Whenever boys come over to date my daughter, I do my best to give them the impression that if they were looking for fun, they should have picked some other girl. My motto: wilt 'em in the living room and they'll stay wilted all night. To assist their understanding, I have come up with some basic rules, which I have carved into two stone tablets on display in my living room.

4NG Fanatics

Rule One: If you pull into my driveway and honk you'd better be delivering a package, because you're sure as heck not picking anything up.

Rule Two: You do not touch my daughter in front of me. You may glance at her, so long as you do not peer at anything below her neck. If you cannot keep your eyes or hands off of my daughter's body, I will remove them.

Rule Three: I am aware that it is considered fashionable for boys of your age to wear their trousers so loosely that they appear to be falling off their hips. Please don't take this as an insult, but you and all of your friends are complete idiots. Still, I want to be fair and open minded about this issue, so I propose this compromise: You may come to the door with your underwear showing and your pants ten sizes too big, and I will not object. However, In order to assure that your clothes do not, in fact, come off during the course of your date with my daughter, I will take my electric staple gun and fasten your trousers securely in place around your waist.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

Rule Four: I'm sure you've been told that in today's world, sex without utilizing a "barrier method" of some kind can kill you. Let me elaborate: when it comes to sex, I am the barrier, and I WILL kill you.

Rule Five: You may believe that in order for us to get to know each other, we should talk about sports, politics, and other issues of the day. Please do not do this. The only information I require from you is an indication of when you expect to have my daughter safely back at my house, and the only word I need from you on this subject is "early."

Rule Six: I have no doubt you are a popular fellow, with many opportunities to date other girls. This is fine with me as long as it is okay with my daughter. Otherwise, once you have gone out with my little girl, you will continue to date no one but her until she is finished with you. If you make her cry, I will make YOU cry.

Rule Seven: As you stand in my front hallway, waiting for my daughter to appear, and more than an hour goes by, do not sigh and fidget. If you want to be on time for the movie,

4NG Fanatics

you should not be dating. My daughter is putting on her makeup, a process which can take longer than painting the Golden Gate Bridge. Instead of just standing there, why don't you do something useful, like changing the oil in my car?

Rule Eight: The following places are not appropriate for a date with my daughter:

- Places where there are beds, sofas, or anything softer than a wooden stool.
- Places where parents, policemen, or nuns are not within eyesight.
- Places where there is darkness.
- Places where there is dancing, holding hands, or happiness.
- Places where the ambient temperature is warm enough to induce my daughter to wear shorts, tank tops, midriff T-shirts, or anything other than a goose down parka zipped up to her chin.
- Movies with a strong romantic or sexual theme are to be avoided; movies which feature chain saws are okay.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

My daughter claims it embarrasses her to come downstairs and find me attempting to get her date to recite these eight simple rules from memory. I'd be embarrassed too--there are only eight of them, for crying out loud!

My wife says I'm being too hard on the boys. "Don't you remember being that age?" she challenges. Of course, I remember. Why do you think I came up with the eight simple rules?

4NG Fanatics

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: W. Bruce Cameron
Book: 8 Simple Rules for Dating My Teenage Daughter: And other tips from a beleaguered father [not that any of them work] Pg 229
ISBN: 978-0761126331
Publisher: Workman Publishing Company
Date (Month/Year): March 2002

AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier – MS
NIETOC
KS State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY